Personalized Meal Plan

by Diabetes and Endocrinology Centre

Consolidated Meal Plan

Meal Plan

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
Monday	Tofu and Spinach Juk (Korean Rice Porridge, cauliflower rice base)	Korean Bibimbap Bowl (cauliflower rice, assorted sautéed veggies, tofu, gochujang, gluten-free)	Korean Sundubu Jjigae (spicy soft tofu stew, mushrooms, zucchini, low sodium, gluten-free)	Spicy Roasted Edamame (air-fried, chili flakes)
Tuesday	Vegetarian Congee with Mushrooms and Ginger (gluten-free)	Filipino Laing (taro leaves in coconut milk, tofu, chili, served with cauliflower rice)	Chinese Buddha's Delight (Luo Han Zhai, assorted vegetables, tofu, wood ear mushrooms, gluten-free)	Crispy Seaweed Sheets with Tamari
Wednesday	Chive and Tofu Pancakes (rice flour, air-fried)	Chinese Mapo Tofu (vegetarian, silken tofu, mushrooms, spicy sauce, gluten-free, low sodium tamari)	Filipino Vegetarian Kare-Kare (peanut stew, eggplant, bok choy, tofu, served with cauliflower rice)	Fresh Mango Slices with Lime and Chili
Thursday	Filipino Ginisang Ampalaya (bitter melon stir-fried with tofu)	Spicy Szechuan Stir-Fry with Tofu, Broccoli, and Bell Peppers (served with konjac noodles)	Korean Gochujang Tofu Lettuce Wraps (tofu, spicy sauce, crunchy veggies)	Korean Cucumber Kimchi (oi muchim, crunchy, spicy)
Friday	Spicy Kimchi Cauliflower Rice Bowl	Korean Doenjang Jjigae (soybean paste stew, mushrooms, tofu, zucchini, low sodium, gluten-free)	Chinese Hot and Sour Soup (tofu, mushrooms, bamboo shoots, gluten-free, low sodium)	Blender Taho (silken tofu, stevia-sweetened sago pearls, vanilla)
Saturday	Vegetarian Japchae (sweet potato noodles, tofu, spinach, carrots, gluten-free)	Filipino Chop Suey (mixed vegetables, tofu, light garlic sauce, gluten-free)	Filipino Tortang Talong (eggplant omelet with chickpea flour, air-fried, served with garlic cauliflower rice)	Air-Fried Shiitake Mushroom Chips
Sunday	Chinese Steamed Silken Tofu with Chili Soy Drizzle (tamari, air-fried green beans)	Chinese Eggplant with Garlic Sauce (tofu, air-fried, gluten-free, served with cauliflower rice)	Korean Spicy Stir-Fried Tofu and Zucchini (gochugaru, scallions, served with konjac noodles)	Filipino Ensaladang Lato (sea grapes salad, tomato, onion, vinegar, chili)

Recipes

Low-Sodium Tofu and Spinach Juk (Korean-Style Rice Porridge, Vegetarian, Low-Carb)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 10 g
Carbs: 7 g
Fat: 5 g

Ingredients

• Soft or silken tofu – 200g (about 7 oz), cubed
• Fresh spinach – 60g (2 packed cups), washed and chopped
• Cauliflower rice (fresh or frozen) – 1 cup (150g)
• Low-sodium vegetable broth – 2 cups (480ml)
• Garlic – 2 cloves, minced
• Ginger – 1 tsp, freshly grated
• Sesame oil – 1 tsp
• Green onion – 1 stalk, thinly sliced (green part only)
• White pepper – 1/8 tsp (optional)
• Toasted sesame seeds – 1 tsp (optional, for garnish)
• Water – up to 1/2 cup (as needed for consistency)

Instructions

1. Set your Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add the sesame oil, then the minced garlic and ginger. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant.
2. Add the cauliflower rice and freshly chopped spinach. Stir for 1-2 minutes until spinach is wilted.
3. Pour in the low-sodium vegetable broth. Bring to a simmer, stirring occasionally.
4. Add the cubed tofu gently to avoid breaking it up. (For extra smoothness, you can blend half the tofu with a small amount of broth before adding, but this is optional.)

5. Cancel 'Sauté' mode. Secure the Instant Pot lid and set to 'Pressure Cook' (Manual, High) for 2 minutes. Let the pressure release naturally for 5 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.
6. Open the lid and gently stir. Adjust consistency by adding water if it is too thick.
7. Add white pepper to taste. Garnish with sliced green onion and toasted sesame seeds before serving (optional).
8. Serve hot. Portion into bowls for immediate consumption.

Vegetarian Congee with Mushrooms and Ginger (East Asian Style, Low Carb & High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 102 kcal
Protein: 8 g
Carbs: 8 g
Fat: 4 g

Ingredients

• 1/2 cup cauliflower rice (fresh or frozen, finely chopped)
• 1/4 cup firm tofu, diced into 1/2-inch cubes
• 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms, thinly sliced (fresh or rehydrated dried, stems removed)
• 1/2 cup king oyster mushrooms, sliced (or substitute with enoki or button mushrooms)
• 1 tablespoon peeled fresh ginger, julienned
• 1 clove garlic, minced
• 2 cups low-sodium vegetable broth (look for <140mg sodium per cup, or make your own)
• 1/2 cup water
• 1 tablespoon shelled edamame (thawed if frozen)
• 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1 green onion, thinly sliced (green part only, for garnish)
• 1 tablespoon cilantro, chopped (optional garnish)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce, optional, check sodium content)
• 1 teaspoon rice vinegar (unseasoned, no sugar or salt added)
• 1/4 teaspoon monk fruit sweetener or erythritol (optional, for slight sweetness)

Instructions

1. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add sesame oil, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant, but not browned.
2. Add all mushrooms and cook for 2-3 minutes, stirring, until slightly softened.
3. Add diced tofu, cauliflower rice, edamame, low-sodium vegetable broth, and water. Stir well.
4. Cancel 'Sauté'. Secure the lid. Set Instant Pot to 'Pressure Cook' on high for 5 minutes.
5. Allow a natural pressure release for 5 minutes, then carefully quick release remaining pressure.
6. Open the lid. Stir in white pepper, optional tamari (check sodium content and use sparingly), rice vinegar, and monk fruit sweetener if desired. Taste and adjust seasoning (avoid adding salt).
7. Ladle congee into bowls. Garnish with fresh green onion and cilantro.
8. Serve hot.

East Asian Chive and Tofu Pancakes (Korean-Inspired, Vegetarian, Low-Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 7g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• 200g firm tofu (well-drained and pressed)
• 40g Chinese chives (about 1 cup, finely chopped)
• 30g scallions (about 2, finely sliced)
• 50g mung bean flour (about 1/2 cup, gluten-free, low-glycemic alternative to wheat flour)
• 40ml unsweetened soy milk (about 3 tbsp)
• 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
• 2 tbsp water (for flaxseed mixture)
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil (use sparingly for flavor, heart-healthy fats)
• 1/2 tsp white pepper

• 1/4 tsp garlic powder
• 1/4 tsp ginger powder
• 1/2 tsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari (for batter; optional, can omit for ultra-low sodium)
• Cooking spray or 1 tsp avocado oil (for air fryer or pan)

Instructions

1. In a small bowl, combine ground flaxseed and 2 tbsp water. Stir and let sit for 5 minutes to form a "flax egg".
2. Pat the tofu dry and crumble it into a large mixing bowl using your hands or a fork.
3. Add chopped Chinese chives, scallions, mung bean flour, and all seasonings (white pepper, garlic powder, ginger powder, and optional low-sodium tamari) to the bowl.
4. Add the flaxseed mixture and unsweetened soy milk. Mix everything together until a thick batter forms. If too dry, add an additional 1-2 tsp soy milk; if too wet, sprinkle in a little more mung bean flour.
5. Preheat your air fryer to 375°F (190°C) for 3 minutes, or prepare a nonstick skillet with a light spray of avocado oil over medium heat.
6. Form the batter into 6 small pancakes (about 2.5 inches diameter each), pressing them gently to hold their shape.
7. For Air Fryer: Arrange pancakes in the basket (in a single layer, work in batches if needed), lightly spray tops with oil, and air fry for 7–8 minutes, flipping halfway, until golden and slightly crisp at the edges.
8. For Skillet: Heat over medium, add pancakes, and cook 3–4 minutes per side until golden brown. Use minimal oil for heart health.
9. Serve warm, optionally with a low-sodium dipping sauce (see tip below).

Vegetarian Filipino Ginisang Ampalaya (Sauteed Bitter Melon) – Low Sodium, High Protein

Nutritional Information

Calories: 124 kcal
Protein: 8.7g
Carbs: 8.2g
Fat: 7.1g

Ingredients

• 2 medium ampalaya (bitter melon), about 350g, seeds removed and sliced thinly
• 1/2 tsp sea salt (for pre-soaking, rinsed off before cooking)

- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 medium red onion, sliced (about 80g)
- 1 medium tomato, diced (about 100g)
- 150g firm tofu, pressed and cut into small cubes
- 1 tbsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos
- 1/2 tsp freshly ground black pepper
- 1/4 cup water
- 1/4 cup chopped scallions (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Slice the ampalaya in half lengthwise. Scoop out seeds and white pith with a spoon. Cut into thin half-moons.
2. Place sliced ampalaya in a bowl, sprinkle evenly with 1/2 tsp sea salt. Rub gently, then fill bowl with water and let soak for 10 minutes to reduce bitterness and sodium content. Drain and rinse thoroughly under running water. Squeeze gently to remove excess water.
3. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add olive oil. When hot, sauté garlic and onion until fragrant and translucent, about 2-3 minutes.
4. Add diced tomato and cook for 2 minutes until softened.
5. Add cubed tofu and sauté for 3-4 minutes until lightly golden.
6. Add ampalaya, black pepper, and tamari (or coconut aminos). Stir well to combine.
7. Pour in 1/4 cup water. Cover and allow to simmer for 4-5 minutes, stirring occasionally, until ampalaya is tender but not mushy.
8. Taste and adjust black pepper if needed. (Do not add extra salt.)
9. Transfer to a serving bowl and garnish with chopped scallions if desired.
10. Serve hot as a main or side dish.

Spicy Kimchi Cauliflower Rice Bowl (Korean-Inspired, Diabetes-Friendly, Vegetarian)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 238 kcal
Protein: 18g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• 2 cups riced cauliflower (fresh or thawed from frozen, unsalted)
• 1/2 cup low-sodium, vegetarian kimchi (ensure no fish sauce, <300mg sodium/serving)
• 1/2 cup firm tofu, pressed and cubed (organic, non-GMO preferred)
• 1/2 cup shelled edamame (thawed if frozen)
• 1/2 cup thinly sliced cucumber
• 1/4 cup shredded carrots
• 2 tbsp green onions, sliced
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1 tbsp low-sodium tamari (gluten-free, or coconut aminos for lowest sodium)
• 1 tbsp gochugaru (Korean chili flakes, or 2 tsp if less spice desired)
• 1/2 tsp grated fresh ginger
• 1 garlic clove, minced
• 1 tsp rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar)
• 1 tsp roasted sesame seeds (optional for garnish)
• Nonstick spray (for air fryer or sauté pan)

Instructions

1. 1. Prep tofu: Pat tofu cubes dry. Air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 10-12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crispy. Alternatively, sauté in a nonstick pan with a light spray of oil until golden.
2. 2. Make spicy sauce: In a small bowl, mix 1 tbsp tamari, 1 tbsp gochugaru, 1/2 tsp ginger, 1 minced garlic clove, 1 tsp rice vinegar, and 1 tsp sesame oil. Set aside.
3. 3. Cook cauliflower rice: Heat a large nonstick pan over medium heat. Lightly spray with oil. Add riced cauliflower and sauté for 4-5 minutes until just tender. Remove from heat.
4. 4. Add edamame to pan (with cauliflower rice) for the last 2 minutes to warm through.
5. 5. Assemble bowls: Divide cauliflower rice and edamame mixture between two bowls. Arrange kimchi, crispy tofu, cucumber, carrots, and green onions on top.
6. 6. Drizzle spicy sauce over bowls. Sprinkle with sesame seeds if desired.
7. 7. Serve immediately, mixing ingredients together before eating.

Low-Carb Vegetarian Japchae (Korean Glass Noodle Stir-fry)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 170 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 10g (net carbs ~4g due to high fiber in shirataki noodles)
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 100g dry shirataki noodles (konjac noodles, rinsed and drained well)
• 1 cup firm tofu (about 120g), pressed and cut into thin strips
• 1/2 cup carrots, julienned
• 1 cup spinach leaves, washed
• 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms, sliced
• 1/2 cup red bell pepper, thinly sliced
• 1/2 cup yellow onion, thinly sliced
• 2 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (divided)
• 1 tablespoon low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for even lower sodium)
• 1 teaspoon rice vinegar (unsweetened)
• 1 teaspoon erythritol or allulose (optional, for balance; do not use sugar)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 teaspoon ginger, freshly grated
• Fresh ground black pepper, to taste
• 1 tablespoon toasted sesame seeds (for garnish)
• 2 scallions, green part only, sliced thin (for garnish)
• Nonstick cooking spray or 1 teaspoon avocado oil (for air frying tofu)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the tofu: Pat the tofu dry, cut into thin strips, and air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 10-12 minutes until golden and slightly crisp, or pan-fry in a nonstick skillet with a spritz of avocado oil until lightly browned. Set aside.
2. 2. Rinse shirataki noodles thoroughly under cold water, then boil for 2-3 minutes. Drain well, then dry in a hot nonstick pan for 1-2 minutes to remove excess moisture. Cut noodles with scissors if too long.
3. 3. In the Instant Pot (on sauté mode) or a large nonstick skillet, add 1 teaspoon sesame oil. Sauté garlic and ginger for 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. 4. Add onions, carrots, mushrooms, and bell pepper. Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until just tender-crisp.
5. 5. Add spinach and stir until wilted (about 1 minute).

6. 6. In a small bowl, whisk together the remaining 1 teaspoon sesame oil, tamari (or coconut aminos), rice vinegar, erythritol/allulose (if using), and black pepper.
7. 7. Add noodles and tofu to the pan with the vegetables. Pour sauce over and toss everything together for 1-2 minutes to heat through and combine flavors.
8. 8. Taste and adjust seasoning with more black pepper or tamari if needed (keeping sodium low).
9. 9. Transfer to serving plates and garnish with toasted sesame seeds and scallions.

Chinese Steamed Silken Tofu with Chili Soy Drizzle (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 102 kcal
Protein: 9g
Carbs: 5g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• Silken tofu (firm style preferred), 1 block (about 400g)
• Low sodium, gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos, 2 teaspoons
• Toasted sesame oil, 1 teaspoon
• Chili oil (low sodium, check for no added MSG), 1/2 teaspoon
• Fresh ginger, finely grated, 1 teaspoon
• Garlic, finely minced, 1 clove
• Green onion, thinly sliced, 1 tablespoon
• Cilantro, chopped, 1 tablespoon
• Roasted unsalted peanuts, chopped, 1/2 tablespoon (optional, for garnish)
• Stevia or monk fruit sweetener, 1/8 teaspoon (optional, for balance)
• Water, 1 tablespoon

Instructions

1. Remove the silken tofu from its packaging and gently drain any excess liquid. Carefully transfer the block to a heatproof plate that fits in your Instant Pot or in a microwave-safe shallow dish.
2. If using Instant Pot: Add 1 cup water to the Instant Pot insert. Place the plate with tofu on the trivet. Cover with foil (to prevent condensation). Set to 'Steam' mode for 3 minutes. Quick release. If using a microwave: Cover the tofu plate loosely with microwave-safe wrap and microwave on high for 2–3 minutes until warmed through.
3. While the tofu steams, prepare the chili soy drizzle: In a small bowl, mix the low sodium tamari (or coconut aminos), toasted sesame oil, chili oil, grated ginger, minced garlic, sweetener, and 1 tablespoon of water. Stir well.
4. Once tofu is steamed, carefully drain any water from the plate. Use a spoon to gently remove excess liquid pooling around the tofu.
5. Drizzle the chili soy mixture evenly over the steamed tofu.
6. Sprinkle with green onion, cilantro, and (if using) chopped peanuts for crunch.
7. Serve immediately as a high-protein, low-carb appetizer or main dish.

Low-Carb Vegetarian Korean Bibimbap Bowl (No Egg, Low Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 235 kcal
Protein: 16g
Carbs: 15g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 1 cup cooked cauliflower rice (use fresh or frozen)
• 100g (3.5 oz) extra-firm tofu, pressed and cubed
• 1/2 cup mung bean sprouts, rinsed
• 1/2 cup baby spinach leaves, washed
• 1/4 cup julienned carrots
• 1/4 cup cucumber, thinly sliced
• 1/4 cup shiitake mushrooms, sliced
• 1/2 sheet roasted unsalted nori (seaweed), cut into thin strips
• 1 green onion, thinly sliced
• 1 tsp toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)

- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil (divided)
- 1 tsp avocado oil (or other neutral oil)
- 1 tbsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for soy-free)
- 1 tbsp Korean gochujang-style sauce (low-sugar, gluten-free, see below)
- 1 tsp rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar/salt)
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- Fresh ground black pepper, to taste

Instructions

1. Prepare tofu: Pat tofu dry and cut into 1/2-inch cubes. In a bowl, gently toss tofu cubes with 1/2 tsp sesame oil, 1/2 tbsp tamari, and a pinch of black pepper. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden OR oven-bake at 425°F (218°C) for 15-20 minutes.
2. Prepare spinach & bean sprouts: Place spinach and mung bean sprouts in a microwave-safe bowl. Microwave for 60-90 seconds until just wilted. Drain excess water and let cool.
3. Sauté mushrooms & carrots: Heat 1 tsp avocado oil in a nonstick pan or Instant Pot sauté mode. Add sliced shiitake mushrooms and carrots. Sauté for 3-5 minutes until tender. Add a splash (1/2 tbsp) of tamari and stir. Remove from heat.
4. Prepare cauliflower rice: If using frozen, microwave as per package. For fresh, pulse cauliflower florets in a blender until rice-sized, then microwave for 2-3 minutes. Fluff with a fork and season with 1/2 tsp sesame oil.
5. Make the low-sugar gochujang sauce: Mix 1 tbsp low-sugar, gluten-free gochujang (store-bought or homemade*), 1 tsp rice vinegar, 1 tbsp water, and 1 minced garlic clove. Adjust with a splash more water if needed for drizzling.
6. Assemble bowls: Divide cauliflower rice between serving bowls. Arrange tofu, sautéed mushrooms & carrots, wilted spinach & bean sprouts, cucumber, and nori strips in sections around the bowl.
7. Drizzle with gochujang sauce, garnish with green onion and toasted sesame seeds if desired. Serve immediately.

Vegetarian Filipino Laing (Low Sodium, High Protein, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 235 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 14g

Ingredients

- 200g dried taro leaves (or 500g fresh, thoroughly washed and sliced)
- 200g firm tofu, cubed (for protein)
- 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or canola oil, for heart-healthy fat)
- 1 medium red onion, finely chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 thumb-sized piece ginger, julienned
- 2 long green chili peppers, sliced (seeded for less heat, optional)
- 1/2 cup red bell pepper, thinly sliced
- 400ml (1 can) light coconut milk (unsweetened, no added sodium)
- 1/2 cup coconut cream (unsweetened, optional for creaminess)
- 1 tablespoon low-sodium soy sauce (gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos preferred, optional or to taste)
- 1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1 tablespoon nutritional yeast (for umami and extra protein, optional)
- 1 tablespoon fresh calamansi juice (or use lime/lemon, optional)
- Fresh cilantro or green onions, chopped, for garnish

Instructions

1. If using dried taro leaves, rinse them gently and soak in warm water for at least 30 minutes. Drain and squeeze out excess water. If using fresh, wash thoroughly and ensure no sap remains (as raw taro can irritate skin and throat).
2. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add the avocado oil. Sauté onion, garlic, and ginger for 2-3 minutes until fragrant.
3. Add the tofu cubes. Sauté for another 2-3 minutes until lightly browned.
4. Stir in the bell pepper and green chili (if using). Sauté for 1 minute.
5. Add the taro leaves. Stir gently until they begin to wilt (for fresh) or soften (for dried, after soaking).
6. Pour in the coconut milk and coconut cream. Stir to combine, making sure all ingredients are submerged.
7. Add low-sodium soy sauce (or alternative), black pepper, and nutritional yeast. Mix gently.
8. Cancel 'Sauté' mode. Set Instant Pot to 'Pressure Cook' (Manual) on LOW pressure for 8 minutes. If using stovetop, simmer covered on low for 20-25 minutes, stirring occasionally.
9. After cooking, quick-release the pressure. Open the lid carefully. If the mixture is too wet, use 'Sauté' mode to simmer for a few minutes, stirring often, until thickened.
10. Turn off heat. Stir in calamansi (or lime/lemon) juice.
11. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed (add more pepper or a dash more low-sodium soy sauce if necessary, but keep sodium intake low).
12. Serve hot, garnished with chopped cilantro or green onions.

Low Sodium, Vegetarian Chinese Mapo Tofu (Diabetes-Friendly, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 235 kcal
Protein: 21g
Carbs: 12g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• 400g (14oz) firm or medium-firm tofu (preferably organic, non-GMO)
• 1 tbsp avocado oil or canola oil (heart-healthy, neutral flavor)
• 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
• 1 tbsp ginger, finely minced
• 2 scallions (green onions), white and green parts separated, thinly sliced
• 80g (about 1/2 cup) shiitake mushrooms, finely diced (fresh preferred, stems removed)
• 1 tbsp Sichuan peppercorns, lightly crushed (optional, for authentic flavor)
• 1.5 tbsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari (instead of soy sauce; ensures low sodium & gluten-free)
• 1.5 tbsp chili bean paste (doubanjiang), low sodium or reduced-sodium if available, or use 1 tbsp Korean gochugaru (mild Korean red pepper flakes) for less sodium
• 2 tbsp water or sodium-free vegetable broth
• 1 tbsp cornstarch mixed with 2 tbsp water (slurry, for thickening)
• 1/2 tsp toasted sesame oil (optional, for flavor; use sparingly due to fat content)
• 1/2 cup frozen shelled edamame, thawed (for extra plant protein)
• 1/2 tsp monk fruit sweetener or erythritol (optional, to balance heat, diabetes-safe)
• Fresh cilantro, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Drain tofu and gently press between paper towels to remove excess water. Cut into 1/2-inch cubes.
2. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' (or use a large nonstick skillet over medium heat). Add avocado oil.
3. Add crushed Sichuan peppercorns (if using), allow to infuse oil for 30 seconds, then add garlic, ginger, and the white parts of the scallions. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant.
4. Add diced shiitake mushrooms. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until softened.

5. Stir in chili bean paste (or gochugaru), stir for 1 minute. Add tamari and water (or sodium-free vegetable broth). Mix well.
6. Add tofu cubes and gently stir to coat them in the sauce. Add thawed edamame.
7. Pour in the cornstarch slurry, gently stir to thicken the sauce (about 1-2 minutes). If using Instant Pot, switch to 'Keep Warm' and allow to thicken, stirring occasionally.
8. Turn off heat. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil (if using). Sprinkle monk fruit sweetener or erythritol if you want a subtle sweetness.
9. Garnish with green parts of scallions and fresh cilantro, if desired.
10. Serve hot. (Avoid serving with rice to keep low carb; serve with steamed broccoli, bok choy, or cauliflower rice for extra fiber.)

Spicy Szechuan Stir-Fry with Tofu, Broccoli, and Bell Peppers

Nutritional Information

Calories: 265 kcal
Protein: 18g
Carbs: 15g (net carbs ~10g; fiber ~5g)
Fat: 15g

Ingredients

• 400g (14oz) firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1-inch cubes
• 2 cups broccoli florets (about 180g)
• 1 large red bell pepper, sliced (about 120g)
• 1 large yellow bell pepper, sliced (about 120g)
• 2 tablespoons avocado oil or canola oil (for high-heat cooking)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, minced
• 1 tablespoon low-sodium gluten-free tamari
• 1 tablespoon rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar or salt)
• 2 teaspoons Szechuan peppercorns, crushed
• 1-2 teaspoons chili garlic sauce (look for no-added-sugar & low-sodium varieties, or use Korean gochugaru flakes for spice)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil (optional, for flavor)
• 2 tablespoons water
• 1 teaspoon cornstarch (gluten-free)

• 2 green onions, sliced (green parts only)
• 1 tablespoon fresh cilantro, chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Press tofu for at least 20 minutes to remove excess moisture. Cut into 1-inch cubes.
2. In a small bowl, mix together the gluten-free tamari, rice vinegar, chili garlic sauce (or gochugaru), and 2 tablespoons water. Set aside.
3. In another small bowl, dissolve cornstarch in 1 tablespoon water. Set aside.
4. Heat 1 tablespoon avocado or canola oil in a large nonstick skillet, wok, or Instant Pot (on 'Sauté' mode) over medium-high heat.
5. Add tofu cubes in a single layer. Air fry (if using air fryer) at 400°F for 10-12 minutes until golden, or pan-fry for 2-3 minutes on each side until golden. Remove and set aside.
6. Add remaining 1 tablespoon oil to the pan/wok. Add garlic, ginger, and crushed Szechuan peppercorns. Stir-fry for 30 seconds until fragrant.
7. Add broccoli and bell peppers. Stir-fry for 3-4 minutes until vegetables are just tender but still crisp.
8. Return tofu to the pan. Stir the sauce mixture, then pour over tofu and vegetables. Toss to coat evenly.
9. Stir the cornstarch slurry, then add to the pan. Stir-fry for 1 minute until the sauce thickens and everything is well coated.
10. Turn off heat. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil (if using) and toss.
11. Garnish with sliced green onions and cilantro before serving.

Low-Sodium Vegetarian Doenjang Jjigae (Korean Soybean Paste Stew)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 145 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• Low-sodium doenjang (Korean fermented soybean paste, gluten-free): 1.5 tbsp (about 22g)
• Water: 3 cups (720ml)
• Firm tofu (organic, drained and cubed): 180g (about 6oz)
• Zucchini (halved lengthwise and sliced): 70g (½ small)

- King oyster or shiitake mushrooms (sliced): 70g (½ cup)
- Daikon radish (peeled and cubed): 50g (¼ cup)
- Onion (sliced): 40g (¼ medium)
- Garlic (minced): 2 cloves (8g)
- Red bell pepper (sliced): 40g (¼ medium)
- Green onion (chopped): 1 stalk (10g)
- Silken tofu (optional, for extra protein and creaminess): 60g (2oz)
- Blanched spinach: 30g (small handful)
- Toasted sesame oil: 1 tsp (5ml)
- Fresh chili (optional, thinly sliced): ½ small
- Black pepper: to taste

Instructions

1. In a medium saucepan or Instant Pot (using sauté mode), add water and bring to a simmer.
2. Whisk in the low-sodium doenjang until fully dissolved.
3. Add onion, garlic, daikon radish, and mushrooms. Simmer uncovered for 5 minutes.
4. Add zucchini, red bell pepper, and simmer for another 3 minutes.
5. Gently add firm tofu cubes and optional silken tofu. Continue to simmer for 3-4 more minutes, until vegetables are tender.
6. Add blanched spinach and green onion. Stir gently.
7. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil and add freshly ground black pepper to taste. Add sliced chili for heat if desired.
8. Taste and adjust seasoning. Avoid adding salt or soy sauce due to sodium restrictions.
9. Ladle into bowls and serve hot.

Filipino Vegetarian Chop Suey (Low Carb, Low Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 160 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or canola oil, for high-heat and heart health)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 medium red onion, sliced
• 1 cup firm tofu, pressed and cubed (about 150g)
• 1 cup cauliflower florets (replace traditional baby corn for lower carbs)
• 1/2 cup snow peas, ends trimmed
• 1/2 cup carrots, sliced thinly on the bias
• 1/2 cup green beans, cut into 2-inch pieces
• 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms, sliced
• 1/2 small red bell pepper, sliced
• 1/4 cup water
• 2 tablespoons coconut aminos (low sodium, gluten-free alternative to soy sauce)
• 1 tablespoon oyster mushroom sauce (gluten-free, vegetarian; use only if sodium content per tablespoon is <200mg, else omit and add extra coconut aminos)
• 1 teaspoon cornstarch or arrowroot powder (for thickening, optional)
• 1 tablespoon cold water (for slurry)
• Fresh ground black pepper, to taste
• Chopped scallions and cilantro, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare all vegetables and tofu as listed above.
2. If using the Instant Pot: Set to 'Sauté' mode. Add avocado oil.
3. Add garlic and onions. Sauté for 2 minutes until fragrant and translucent.
4. Add cubed tofu. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until lightly golden on most sides.
5. Add carrots, green beans, and cauliflower. Sauté for 2 minutes.
6. Add mushrooms, snow peas, and bell pepper. Stir well.
7. Pour in 1/4 cup water, coconut aminos, and mushroom sauce (if using). Stir and cover. Let steam for 3-4 minutes until veggies are just tender-crisp.
8. In a small bowl, mix cornstarch or arrowroot powder with 1 tablespoon cold water to make a slurry. Add to the pot and stir well (optional, for thicker sauce).
9. Cook for 1 more minute until sauce slightly thickens.
10. Season with fresh ground black pepper to taste.
11. Turn off heat. Transfer to serving dish and garnish with scallions and cilantro if desired.

Chinese Eggplant with Garlic Sauce (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 180 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 2 medium Chinese eggplants (about 400g), cut into 2-inch batons
• 1 block (200g) firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
• 4 cloves garlic, minced
• 1-inch piece ginger, peeled and minced
• 2 scallions, white and green parts separated, sliced
• 1/2 red bell pepper, thinly sliced (optional, for color and nutrition)
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil or canola oil
• 2 tablespoons low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative; ensure lowest sodium available, e.g., 280mg per tablespoon)
• 1 tablespoon rice vinegar
• 1 tablespoon water
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1 teaspoon arrowroot starch (or cornstarch), mixed with 1 tablespoon water
• 1/2 teaspoon monk fruit sweetener (or stevia, optional, for balance)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (optional, for heat)
• Fresh cilantro or additional scallion greens, for garnish

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare tofu: Press the tofu for at least 10 minutes to remove excess water, then cut into 1/2-inch cubes.
2. 2. Air fry tofu: Place tofu cubes in the air fryer basket, spray lightly with oil, and cook at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. Set aside.
3. 3. Prepare eggplant: Toss eggplant batons in 1 teaspoon oil. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 8-10 minutes, shaking halfway, until just tender and lightly browned. (Alternatively, microwave eggplant for 3-4 minutes until softened if air fryer not available.) Set aside.
4. 4. Make sauce: In a small bowl, combine low-sodium tamari, rice vinegar, water, sesame oil, monk fruit sweetener, ground white pepper, and (optional) red pepper flakes. Set aside.
5. 5. Sauté aromatics: Heat remaining oil in a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium heat. Add garlic, ginger, and white parts of scallions. Stir-fry for 1 minute until fragrant.
6. 6. Add bell pepper (if using) and cook for 2 minutes until slightly softened.
7. 7. Combine: Add cooked eggplant and tofu to the skillet. Stir to mix.
8. 8. Pour in sauce. Stir well. When simmering, add arrowroot/water slurry and stir until sauce thickens and glazes the vegetables (about 1 minute).
9. 9. Turn off heat. Garnish with scallion greens and cilantro.
10. 10. Serve hot, ideally with a side of steamed non-starchy vegetables (e.g., broccoli) for extra fiber and volume.

Vegetarian Korean Sundubu Jjigae (Soft Tofu Stew) – Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 11g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 300g silken (soft) tofu (unsalted, organic preferred)
• 120g fresh shiitake mushrooms, sliced
• 100g enoki mushrooms, trimmed
• 1/2 small zucchini, thinly sliced (about 60g)
• 50g firm smoked tofu, diced (for texture & protein boost)
• 1/2 small onion, thinly sliced (about 40g)

• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1/2 tbsp ginger, minced
• 1 tbsp low-sodium gochugaru (Korean chili flakes, mild; check sodium content carefully)
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1 tbsp low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative)
• 2 tsp white or yellow miso paste (reduced sodium, gluten-free)
• 2 cups low-sodium vegetarian or mushroom broth (homemade or no-salt-added)
• 1/2 sheet gim (roasted seaweed, unsalted), shredded (optional garnish)
• 1 stalk green onion, chopped (green part only, for garnish)
• Fresh ground black pepper to taste
• 1/2 tsp erythritol or monkfruit sweetener (optional, for balance)
• 1/2 tsp rice vinegar (optional, for brightness)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare all vegetables: slice shiitake and enoki mushrooms, zucchini, onion, and green onion; mince garlic and ginger.
2. 2. In the Instant Pot (using sauté mode) or a large nonstick saucepan, heat sesame oil over medium heat. Add onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 1-2 minutes until fragrant but not browned.
3. 3. Add the gochugaru and stir for 30 seconds to bloom the chili flavor.
4. 4. Add shiitake and enoki mushrooms, zucchini, and smoked tofu. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until mushrooms begin to soften.
5. 5. Pour in the low-sodium broth. Stir in tamari and miso paste (dissolve miso in a little warm broth before adding to avoid clumps). Add optional erythritol and rice vinegar if using.
6. 6. Bring to a gentle simmer (if using Instant Pot, switch to 'soup' or low sauté setting and simmer uncovered).
7. 7. Gently add the silken tofu in large spoonfuls (do not stir vigorously to keep tofu intact). Simmer gently for 5-6 minutes until flavors meld and tofu is heated through.
8. 8. Taste and adjust seasoning with black pepper. Avoid adding extra salt.
9. 9. Ladle into bowls. Garnish with chopped green onion and shredded gim (seaweed). Serve hot.

Low-Sodium, High-Protein Buddha's Delight (Luo Han Zhai) – Diabetic & Heart-Healthy

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal

Protein: 14g
Carbs: 17g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 200g firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1-inch cubes
• 100g fresh shiitake mushrooms, sliced (or rehydrated dried shiitake)
• 100g wood ear mushrooms, soaked and sliced
• 100g napa cabbage, chopped
• 100g baby bok choy, halved
• 80g snow peas, trimmed
• 80g carrots, julienned
• 1/2 cup bamboo shoots, sliced
• 1/2 cup water chestnuts, sliced
• 1/2 cup mung bean sprouts
• 2 tablespoons avocado oil or canola oil (heart-healthy choice)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, minced
• 1 tablespoon low-sodium, gluten-free tamari
• 1 tablespoon Shaoxing wine (optional, for flavor; omit for alcohol-free)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/2 teaspoon white pepper
• 1/4 teaspoon salt substitute (potassium chloride-based, optional and only if approved by physician)
• 1 cup low-sodium vegetable broth (look for unsalted, gluten-free brands)
• 1 tablespoon cornstarch (or arrowroot), mixed with 2 tablespoons water (slurry for thickening)
• Chopped scallions and cilantro for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare all vegetables and tofu as described. If using dried mushrooms or wood ear fungus, soak in hot water for 20 minutes, drain, and slice.
2. 2. Heat 1 tablespoon avocado oil in an Instant Pot (set to Sauté function) or wok over medium-high heat.
3. 3. Add tofu cubes and sear on all sides until golden (about 3-4 minutes). Remove and set aside.
4. 4. Add remaining oil, then sauté garlic and ginger for 30 seconds until fragrant.
5. 5. Add mushrooms, carrots, bamboo shoots, water chestnuts, napa cabbage, and bok choy. Sauté for 2-3 minutes.

6. 6. Stir in snow peas and mung bean sprouts. Sauté for 1 more minute.
7. 7. Return tofu to the pot. Pour in low-sodium vegetable broth, tamari, Shaoxing wine (if using), white pepper, and salt substitute (if approved). Stir gently.
8. 8. Bring to a simmer (Instant Pot: Switch to 'Keep Warm' once simmering). Cover and cook for 5 minutes until vegetables are just tender.
9. 9. Stir the cornstarch slurry to recombine, then drizzle into the pot while stirring. Cook for another 1-2 minutes until broth thickens slightly.
10. 10. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (avoid excess salt).
11. 11. Serve hot, garnished with chopped scallions and cilantro if desired.

Filipino Vegetarian Kare-Kare (Low-Carb, Low-Sodium, High-Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 285 kcal
Protein: 16 g
Carbs: 22 g
Fat: 13 g

Ingredients

• 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
• 1 small red onion, finely chopped
• 3 cloves garlic, minced
• 1-inch piece fresh ginger, minced
• 1 medium eggplant (about 200g), cut into 1-inch cubes
• 1 cup green beans, trimmed and cut into 2-inch lengths
• 1 cup broccoli florets
• 1 cup baby bok choy, halved lengthwise
• 1 (14-oz/400g) can low-sodium chickpeas, drained and rinsed
• 200g firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1-inch cubes
• 2 tablespoons natural unsweetened peanut butter (no salt, no added sugar)
• 1 tablespoon ground roasted peanuts (unsalted, for garnish)
• 1 tablespoon ground toasted rice (optional, for thickening and authenticity)
• 2 cups low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade or no-salt-added store-bought)

• 1 tablespoon coconut aminos (gluten-free, low-sodium soy sauce alternative)
• 1 teaspoon annatto powder (for color, optional)
• 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon lemon juice (or calamansi juice, if available)
• 1/2 cup sliced banana heart (puso ng saging), soaked and squeezed (optional, traditional)
• Fresh cilantro or scallions, for garnish

Instructions

1. If using, press tofu for 30 minutes to remove excess moisture. Cube and air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes until golden, or pan-sear in 1/2 tablespoon olive oil until lightly crisped. Set aside.
2. In the Instant Pot (or large nonstick skillet), heat remaining olive oil on Sauté mode. Add onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté until fragrant and softened (about 2-3 minutes).
3. Stir in the annatto powder (if using) for color, then add eggplant and banana heart (if using). Sauté 2 more minutes.
4. Add green beans, broccoli, and chickpeas. Pour in the vegetable broth and bring to a gentle simmer (use 'Sauté' or 'Pressure Cook' for 1 minute on high and quick release).
5. In a small bowl, whisk peanut butter with coconut aminos, lemon juice, and 1/4 cup of hot broth from the pot until smooth.
6. Stir peanut sauce into the vegetable mixture. Add the ground toasted rice for thickening if desired. Simmer 3-5 minutes until vegetables are just tender but not mushy.
7. Gently fold in the crisped tofu and bok choy. Simmer 2 minutes until bok choy is just wilted.
8. Season with black pepper. Taste and adjust acidity or peanut flavor as desired (do not add salt for low-sodium compliance).
9. Ladle into bowls. Garnish with ground roasted peanuts and fresh cilantro or scallions before serving.

Korean Gochujang Tofu Lettuce Wraps (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Low Sugar, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 165 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

- Extra-firm tofu, 400g (pressed and cubed)
- Butter lettuce or red leaf lettuce, 12 large leaves (washed & dried)
- Carrot, 1 small (julienned)
- Cucumber, 1/2 medium (julienned)
- Red bell pepper, 1/2 medium (julienned)
- Green onions, 2 stalks (thinly sliced)
- Toasted sesame seeds, 1 tsp
- Avocado oil, 1 tbsp (or other neutral oil)
- Low sodium, gluten-free gochujang, 1.5 tbsp (see note below)
- Rice vinegar, 1 tbsp
- Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener, 1 tsp
- Low sodium tamari or coconut aminos, 2 tsp
- Garlic, 2 cloves (minced)
- Fresh ginger, 1/2 tsp (minced)
- Water, 2 tbsp
- Optional: Korean perilla leaves, 4-6 (for added flavor, if available)

Instructions

1. Press tofu for 20 minutes to remove excess moisture. Cut into 2 cm cubes.
2. Make the sauce: In a bowl, whisk together low sodium, gluten-free gochujang, rice vinegar, erythritol (or monk fruit sweetener), low sodium tamari, minced garlic, minced ginger, and water until smooth.
3. Toss tofu cubes gently with half of the sauce in a bowl. Reserve the other half of the sauce for drizzling.
4. Preheat air fryer to 200°C (390°F) for 3 minutes. Arrange tofu cubes in a single layer in the basket. Air fry for 12-14 minutes, shaking halfway, until lightly crisped and browned.
5. While tofu cooks, prepare vegetables: julienne carrot, cucumber, and bell pepper. Slice green onions.
6. Arrange lettuce leaves on a platter. Place a few cubes of cooked tofu on each leaf, then top with carrot, cucumber, bell pepper, and green onions.
7. Drizzle with remaining sauce (divide evenly), and sprinkle with toasted sesame seeds. Add perilla leaves if using.
8. Serve immediately. Wrap and eat with hands.

Vegetarian Chinese Hot and Sour Soup (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein, Gluten-Free, No Egg)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 85 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 2.5g

Ingredients

• 4 cups low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade or no-salt-added)
• 1/2 cup firm tofu, cut into thin matchsticks
• 1/4 cup dried shiitake mushrooms, rehydrated and sliced (reserve soaking liquid)
• 1/2 cup bamboo shoots, julienned (no-salt-added, rinsed well)
• 1/2 cup wood ear mushrooms, rehydrated and sliced (optional)
• 1/2 cup carrot, cut into thin julienne strips
• 2 tablespoons rice vinegar (no added sugar)
• 1 tablespoon low-sodium tamari (gluten-free, or coconut aminos if soy-free)
• 1 tablespoon cornstarch (or arrowroot) mixed with 2 tablespoons cold water (slurry)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground white pepper (or to taste)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1 teaspoon fresh ginger, grated
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1/2 teaspoon chili garlic sauce (sambal oelek, low-sodium, or homemade with no added salt/sugar)
• 2 tablespoons chopped scallions (green parts only, for garnish)
• Fresh cilantro, chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Soak dried shiitake and wood ear mushrooms in hot water for 20 minutes. Reserve the soaking liquid (strain to remove grit), slice mushrooms thinly.

2. 2. In the Instant Pot (or stovetop pot), combine the low-sodium vegetable broth and 1/2 cup reserved mushroom soaking liquid for extra flavor. Set to 'Sauté' mode (or medium-high heat).
3. 3. Add the ginger and garlic. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant.
4. 4. Add rehydrated mushrooms, bamboo shoots, and carrots. Sauté for 2-3 minutes to soften.
5. 5. Stir in the tofu matchsticks and cook for 1 minute.
6. 6. Pour in rice vinegar, tamari (or coconut aminos), chili garlic sauce, white pepper, and black pepper. Mix well.
7. 7. Bring the soup to a gentle simmer (use 'Sauté' or 'Soup' mode on Instant Pot). Simmer for 5 minutes.
8. 8. While stirring gently, slowly add the cornstarch slurry to the soup to thicken. Simmer for 2-3 minutes until the soup thickens slightly.
9. 9. Turn off the heat. Drizzle in toasted sesame oil and mix.
10. 10. Garnish with scallion greens and fresh cilantro (if using). Serve hot.

Vegetarian, High-Protein, Low-Sodium Filipino Tortang Talong (Eggplant Omelette, Egg-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 160 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• 2 medium Asian eggplants (about 250g each)
• 200g firm tofu (well-pressed)
• 2 tablespoons unsweetened soy milk (or other plant milk, unsweetened)
• 1 tablespoon ground flaxseed
• 3 tablespoons water
• 1 small shallot, finely chopped
• 1 clove garlic, minced
• 1/4 cup chopped scallions (green onions)
• 1/4 cup chopped fresh tomatoes (optional)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon turmeric powder (for color, optional)

• 1 tablespoon olive oil or avocado oil (for air frying or pan-frying)
• Non-stick spray (optional, for air fryer)
• 1 teaspoon coconut aminos (low sodium alternative to soy sauce, optional for serving)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the flaxseed 'egg': In a small bowl, mix ground flaxseed with 3 tablespoons water. Let sit for 5 minutes until it forms a gel-like consistency.
2. 2. Roast the eggplants: Wash and dry the eggplants. Using a fork, prick the skin a few times. Place the eggplants in the air fryer at 375°F (190°C) for 15-18 minutes, turning halfway, until the skin is charred and the flesh is soft. Alternatively, roast in a microwave on high for 5-7 minutes, turning once. Let cool until you can handle them.
3. 3. While the eggplants cook, crumble the tofu into a bowl. Add the unsweetened soy milk, flaxseed 'egg', black pepper, turmeric (if using), and mix well. Mash together until mostly smooth but with some texture. Stir in shallots, garlic, and scallions. If using, add chopped tomatoes.
4. 4. Once eggplants are cool, gently peel off the skin, keeping stems intact. Place each eggplant on a flat plate and flatten gently with a fork to a wide oval shape.
5. 5. Spoon and spread half of the tofu mixture evenly over each flattened eggplant, pressing lightly.
6. 6. Cooking (choose preferred method):
7. a. Air Fryer: Spray the air fryer basket with non-stick spray or brush with a little oil. Carefully transfer the topped eggplants to the basket. Air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 7-10 minutes until golden and set. Optionally brush or spray a small amount of oil on top for better browning.
8. b. Pan-fry: Heat 1 tablespoon oil in a nonstick pan over medium heat. Using a large spatula, gently transfer the topped eggplant to the pan, tofu side down. Cook for 3-5 minutes until golden, then carefully flip and cook the stem side for another 2-3 minutes.
9. 7. Serve warm, garnished with extra scallions and accompanied by a small dish of coconut aminos for dipping (use sparingly due to sodium).

Korean Spicy Stir-Fried Tofu and Zucchini (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 11g (net carbs: 7g)
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• Extra-firm tofu – 400g (about 14oz), pressed and cubed
• Zucchini – 2 medium (about 300g), halved lengthwise and sliced
• Carrot – 1 small (about 60g), julienned (optional for color and texture)
• Red bell pepper – 1 small (about 100g), sliced thinly
• Green onion – 2 stalks, chopped (separate white and green parts)
• Garlic – 3 cloves, minced
• Gochugaru (Korean red chili flakes) – 1 tablespoon (adjust to taste, not gochujang to avoid added sugar/sodium)
• Low sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative) – 1 tablespoon
• Toasted sesame oil – 1 teaspoon
• Rice vinegar (unseasoned) – 1 teaspoon
• Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener – 1/2 teaspoon (optional, to balance heat)
• Fresh ginger – 1 teaspoon, grated
• Black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
• Water – 2 tablespoons
• Sesame seeds – 1 teaspoon, for garnish (optional)
• Cooking spray or 1 teaspoon avocado oil (for air fryer or skillet)

Instructions

1. 1. Preparation: Press tofu for at least 15 minutes to remove excess water. Cut into 1-inch cubes.
2. 2. Air Fry Tofu: Lightly spray tofu cubes with cooking spray or toss with 1/2 teaspoon avocado oil. Air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 12-14 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. Alternatively, pan-sear in a nonstick skillet over medium-high heat until all sides are golden.
3. 3. Prepare Sauce: In a small bowl, combine gochugaru, low sodium tamari, rice vinegar, erythritol (if using), grated ginger, black pepper, 2 tablespoons water, and sesame oil. Mix well and set aside.
4. 4. Stir-Fry Vegetables: In a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium heat, add remaining 1/2 teaspoon oil (if using) or a splash of water. Add minced garlic, white parts of green onion, and carrot (if using). Stir-fry for 1 minute.
5. 5. Add zucchini and red bell pepper. Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until just tender but still bright.
6. 6. Add the air-fried tofu to the skillet. Pour the sauce over all ingredients. Toss gently to coat evenly.
7. 7. Stir-fry for 2-3 more minutes over medium-high heat, allowing the sauce to thicken slightly and coat the vegetables and tofu. If needed, add a splash more water for desired sauciness.
8. 8. Remove from heat. Garnish with green parts of green onion and sesame seeds.
9. 9. Serve immediately. Enjoy as a main dish or with a side of cauliflower rice for a low-carb option.

Spicy Roasted Edamame (Korean-Inspired, Low Sodium, Vegetarian)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 165 kcal
Protein: 13 g
Carbs: 11 g
Fat: 8 g

Ingredients

- 2 cups frozen shelled edamame (unsalted, thawed if frozen)
- 1 tablespoon toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed, for flavor and heart-health)
- 1 tablespoon low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos, for less sodium)
- 1 teaspoon Korean gochugaru (Korean red pepper flakes, adjust to taste)
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- 1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)
- 1 green onion, finely sliced (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 400°F (200°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Rinse thawed shelled edamame thoroughly under cold water and pat dry with a clean towel to help them crisp up.
3. In a large mixing bowl, combine sesame oil, low-sodium tamari (or coconut aminos), gochugaru, garlic powder, and black pepper. Mix well.
4. Add the edamame to the bowl and toss until evenly coated with the spice mixture.
5. Spread the seasoned edamame in a single layer in the air fryer basket.
6. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes, shaking the basket halfway through, until the edamame are slightly crisp and golden at the edges.
7. Transfer to a serving bowl. Sprinkle with toasted sesame seeds and green onion, if desired. Serve warm or at room temperature.

Crispy Seaweed Sheets with Low-Sodium Tamari (East Asian Style, Diabetic & Heart-Healthy)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 62 kcal
Protein: 5g
Carbs: 3g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• 8 full-sized sheets roasted nori (unsalted, plain)
• 2 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed, unrefined)
• 1 tablespoon low-sodium gluten-free tamari sauce
• 1 tablespoon shelled roasted edamame or unsalted soy nuts (optional, for protein boost)
• 1/2 teaspoon roasted white sesame seeds

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 320°F (160°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Lay one nori sheet on a clean, dry surface. Using a pastry brush, lightly brush one side of the nori with a small amount of toasted sesame oil. Repeat for all sheets.
3. Stack the nori sheets and, using clean kitchen scissors, cut them into quarters (making 32 small rectangles).
4. Arrange the nori pieces in a single layer in the air fryer basket (you may need to do this in batches). Air fry for 2-3 minutes, or until the nori is crisp but not burnt. Watch closely, as nori can burn quickly.
5. Transfer the crispy nori pieces to a plate. While still warm, drizzle very lightly with low-sodium tamari (use a small spoon or spray bottle to control sodium and moisture).
6. Immediately sprinkle with sesame seeds and, if using, the finely chopped roasted edamame or soy nuts for added protein and texture.
7. Let cool for 2-3 minutes. Serve immediately as a snack or side dish.

East Asian-Inspired Fresh Mango Slices with Lime and Chili

Nutritional Information

Calories: 60 kcal

Protein: 1g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 1g

Ingredients

• Fresh semi-ripe mango, peeled and sliced – 100g (about 1/2 small mango)
• Fresh lime – 1/2 fruit (for juice and zest)
• Chili flakes (Korean gochugaru or Chinese chili flakes, unsalted) – 1/4 tsp
• Toasted white sesame seeds – 1/2 tsp
• Fresh mint leaves – 2-3 leaves, finely sliced (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Wash and peel the mango, then slice into thin, even pieces.
2. Arrange the mango slices on a serving plate.
3. Squeeze the juice of half a lime evenly over the mango slices. Optionally, zest a little lime peel over the top for extra aroma.
4. Sprinkle the chili flakes and toasted sesame seeds evenly over the mango.
5. Garnish with finely sliced fresh mint leaves if desired.
6. Serve immediately as a refreshing, diabetes-friendly East Asian-style snack or light dessert.

Low-Sodium Korean Cucumber Kimchi (Oi Kimchi) – Diabetes & Heart Healthy

Nutritional Information

Calories: 65 kcal
Protein: 5g
Carbs: 7g
Fat: 2g

Ingredients

- English cucumber or Korean cucumber – 2 medium (about 400g), washed and cut into 1/4-inch thick slices
- Kosher salt (low-sodium) – 1/2 teaspoon
- Carrot – 1/2 small (about 30g), julienned
- Scallion – 1 stalk, cut into 2-inch matchsticks
- Garlic – 2 cloves, finely minced
- Ginger – 1/2 teaspoon, finely minced
- Gochugaru (Korean red pepper flakes, mild) – 1 teaspoon
- Toasted sesame seeds – 1 teaspoon
- Rice vinegar (unseasoned, low-sodium) – 1 tablespoon
- Tamari (gluten-free, low-sodium) – 1 teaspoon
- Tofu (firm, plain) – 100g, cut into small cubes (for added plant protein, optional but recommended)
- Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener – 1/2 teaspoon (optional, for balance)
- Filtered water – as needed for rinsing

Instructions

1. Place the cucumber slices in a colander and sprinkle with the 1/2 teaspoon low-sodium kosher salt. Gently toss and let sit for 15-20 minutes to draw out excess moisture.
2. Rinse the cucumbers thoroughly under cold filtered water to remove excess salt. Drain well and gently pat dry with a clean kitchen towel.
3. In a large mixing bowl, combine the drained cucumbers, julienned carrots, scallion, garlic, ginger, gochugaru, toasted sesame seeds, rice vinegar, tamari, and sweetener (if using). Gently toss to evenly coat all the vegetables.
4. If adding tofu for protein, gently fold in the tofu cubes at the end. Be careful not to break them.
5. Transfer the kimchi to a clean, airtight glass container. For best flavor, let it chill in the fridge for at least 1-2 hours before serving. It can be enjoyed immediately, but the flavors improve after a short marination.
6. Serve chilled as a side dish or banchan. Store leftovers in the fridge and consume within 3 days for best texture.

Diabetes-Friendly Blender Taho (Filipino Silken Tofu Dessert)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 8 g
Carbs: 8 g

Fat: 5 g

Ingredients

• Organic silken tofu (unsweetened, shelf-stable or refrigerated) – 300g (about 10.5 oz)
• Unsweetened soy milk – 1/2 cup (120 ml) (preferably calcium-fortified)
• Chia seeds – 1 tablespoon (optional, for fiber and texture)
• Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener – 2 tablespoons (adjust to taste; zero calorie, low glycemic index)
• Pure vanilla extract – 1/4 teaspoon
• Filipino-style sago pearls (small tapioca pearls) – 2 tablespoons dry (about 15g), optionally use konjac pearls for lower carb
• Filtered water – for boiling sago (about 2 cups)
• Pandan leaf – 1 small piece (optional, for authentic aroma)
• Low-sodium soy sauce – 1/8 teaspoon (optional, for umami depth, omit if sodium restriction is very strict)
• Pinch of salt substitute or potassium chloride (optional, if not contraindicated by medications and only if approved by physician)

Instructions

1. Prepare the sago pearls (or konjac pearls): In a small pot or using the Instant Pot, bring 2 cups of filtered water to a boil. Add the sago pearls and pandan leaf (if using). Boil gently, stirring occasionally, for about 15 minutes (or per package instructions) until translucent. Drain and rinse under cold water. Set aside.
2. In a blender, combine the silken tofu, unsweetened soy milk, erythritol/monk fruit sweetener, chia seeds (if using), and vanilla extract. Blend on high until completely smooth and creamy.
3. Taste and adjust sweetness if needed. If using, add the low-sodium soy sauce and salt substitute very sparingly for depth of flavor.
4. To serve: Spoon the blended tofu mixture into two dessert glasses or bowls. Top each with a portion of cooked sago pearls (or konjac pearls).
5. Optional: Warm the tofu mixture briefly in the microwave (30 seconds) if you prefer warm taho, or serve chilled from the fridge.
6. Garnish with an extra sprinkle of chia seeds or a drizzle of more sweetener if desired.

Air-Fried Shiitake Mushroom Chips (Chinese-Korean Style, Diabetes-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 3.4g

Carbs: 7.2g
Fat: 7.2g

Ingredients

• 200g fresh shiitake mushrooms (about 10-12 medium caps), stems removed
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or neutral high-oleic oil, e.g., canola)
• 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
• 1/4 teaspoon white pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon onion powder
• 1/4 teaspoon Korean gochugaru (optional, for mild heat; omit for no spice)
• 1/4 teaspoon low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos (gluten-free, optional for umami; skip for strictest sodium control)
• 1 tablespoon roasted black or white sesame seeds (for garnish)
• 1 small green onion, finely sliced (for garnish, optional)

Instructions

1. Gently clean the shiitake mushrooms with a damp paper towel. Remove stems and slice the caps into 3mm (1/8-inch) thick slices.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together avocado oil, sesame oil, garlic powder, white pepper, onion powder, gochugaru (if using), and low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos (if using).
3. Add the sliced shiitake mushrooms and toss well to coat evenly. Let marinate for 10 minutes to infuse flavor.
4. Preheat your air fryer to 160°C (320°F) for 2-3 minutes.
5. Arrange mushroom slices in a single layer in the air fryer basket (work in batches if needed for even crisping).
6. Air-fry at 160°C (320°F) for 10-12 minutes, shaking the basket or turning the chips halfway through. Watch closely for the last 2-3 minutes to prevent burning; chips should be crisp and golden but not dark brown.
7. Transfer to a plate and sprinkle with sesame seeds and green onion while still warm.
8. Let cool slightly—chips will crisp up more as they cool. Serve immediately as a snack or side.

Filipino Ensaladang Lato (Low-Sodium, Vegetarian, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 61 kcal
Protein: 3g
Carbs: 6g
Fat: 2g

Ingredients

- 100g fresh lato (sea grapes), thoroughly rinsed and drained
- 1 small (60g) ripe tomato, diced
- 1/2 small (25g) red onion, finely chopped
- 1/2 small (35g) cucumber, diced
- 1 tablespoon (10g) firm tofu, finely diced (for added protein)
- 1 tablespoon calamansi juice (or fresh lemon juice if unavailable)
- 1 teaspoon apple cider vinegar (low sodium alternative)
- 1/2 teaspoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 small chili (optional, finely sliced, omit for less spice)
- Fresh cilantro or scallion, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare the lato by rinsing gently under cold running water to remove excess salt. Drain well and set aside.
2. In a mixing bowl, combine the diced tomato, red onion, cucumber, and tofu.
3. In a small bowl or cup, whisk together calamansi (or lemon) juice, apple cider vinegar, olive oil, and black pepper to make the dressing.
4. Pour the dressing over the vegetable-tofu mixture and toss gently.
5. Add the lato and toss lightly to avoid crushing the delicate sea grapes. Adjust seasoning with more calamansi or lemon juice if desired.
6. Top with sliced chili and garnish with fresh cilantro or scallion if using.
7. Serve immediately as a refreshing side salad.

Shopping List

Refrigerated Plant Protein

- Tofu (firm, extra-firm, silken, smoked, plain, organic, non-GMO) - 2.5 kg
- Firm smoked tofu - 100 g

Produce

- Cauliflower (whole head or riced, fresh/frozen) - 2 heads (≈3 lb total)
- Spinach (fresh, baby or regular) - 454 g bag
- Shiitake mushrooms (fresh or dried, stems removed) - 600 g
- King oyster mushrooms (or enoki, button mushrooms, wood ear as needed) - 300 g
- Enoki mushrooms (fresh) - 100 g
- Mung bean sprouts - 250 g
- Baby bok choy - 2 heads (≈1 lb)
- Napa cabbage - 1 head (≈1 lb)
- Carrots - 3 lb
- Zucchini - 3 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Eggplant (Asian/Chinese) - 4 pieces (≈3 lb)
- Red bell pepper - 5 pieces (≈3 lb)
- Yellow bell pepper - 2 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Green beans - 1 lb
- Broccoli florets - 2 lb
- Snow peas - 250 g
- Daikon radish - 1 piece (≈1 lb)
- Cucumber (English or Korean) - 3 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Tomato - 4 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Onion (red and yellow) - 3 lb
- Shallot - 2 pieces
- Scallions / Green onions - 3 bunches

- Chinese chives - 1 bunch
- Ampalaya (bitter melon) - 2 pieces (≈1 lb)
- Lato (sea grapes) - 100 g
- Fresh cilantro - 2 bunches
- Fresh mint - 1 bunch
- Fresh calamansi or limes - 6 pieces
- Fresh lime - 2 pieces
- Fresh ginger root - 0.5 lb
- Fresh garlic - 2 bulbs
- Green chili pepper - 3 pieces
- Banana heart (puso ng saging) - 1 small
- Mango (semi-ripe, fresh) - 2 pieces (≈1 lb)
- Pandan leaf (optional, for aroma) - 1 piece
- Fresh calamansi juice (or substitute with lime/lemon) - See fresh calamansi/limes/lemon above
- Fresh lemon - 2 pieces
- Fresh green onion (for garnish) - See scallions/green onions above
- Fresh cilantro (for garnish) - See cilantro above
- Fresh mint (for garnish) - See mint above
- Fresh scallion (for garnish) - See scallions/green onions above
- Fresh ginger (for garnish) - See ginger above

Dry Goods

- Wood ear mushrooms (dried, soaked as needed) - 150 g
- Sago pearls (Filipino small tapioca) or konjac pearls - 100 g
- Dried taro leaves - 200 g
- Shirataki noodles (dry, konjac noodles) - 200 g (2 × 100 g packs)
- Sago pearls (Filipino-style small tapioca, or konjac pearls for lower carb) - 100 g

Frozen

- Edamame (frozen shelled, unsalted) - 908 g (2 × 454 g bags)

Pantry

- Nori sheets (roasted, unsalted, plain) - 1 package (10 sheets)
- Gim (roasted seaweed, unsalted) - 1 sheet
- Low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for lowest sodium) - 500 ml bottle
- Low-sodium coconut aminos - 250 ml bottle
- Low-sodium doenjang (Korean soybean paste, gluten-free) - 1 tub (250 g)
- Low-sodium gluten-free gochujang (Korean chili paste) - 1 small tub (150 g)
- Gochugaru (Korean chili flakes) - 100 g
- Chili garlic sauce (low sodium, no added sugar) or sambal oelek - 1 jar (100 g)
- Chili oil (low sodium, no MSG) - 1 small bottle (100 ml)
- Korean chili flakes or Chinese chili flakes - 50 g
- Annatto powder - 1 small pack (25 g)
- Rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar/salt) - 500 ml bottle
- Shaoxing wine (optional) - 1 small bottle (375 ml)
- Pure vanilla extract - 1 bottle (60 ml)
- Olive oil (extra-virgin) - 500 ml bottle
- Avocado oil (or canola oil) - 500 ml bottle
- Toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed, unrefined) - 250 ml bottle
- Peanut butter (natural, unsweetened, no salt/sugar) - 250 g jar
- Ground roasted peanuts (unsalted) - 100 g
- Roasted unsalted peanuts - 100 g
- Shelled roasted edamame or unsalted soy nuts - 100 g
- Arrowroot starch (or cornstarch) - 200 g
- Cornstarch - 200 g
- Mung bean flour - 100 g
- Ground flaxseed - 200 g
- Nutritional yeast - 50 g
- Monk fruit sweetener or erythritol - 200 g
- Stevia sweetener - 1 small pack (50 g)
- Allulose (optional, as alternative sweetener) - 100 g
- Low-sodium soy sauce (for occasional, optional use) - 100 ml
- Sichuan peppercorns - 25 g
- Salt substitute (potassium chloride-based, optional) - 1 small container (120 g)

- Kosher salt (low sodium) - 250 g box
- White pepper (ground) - 50 g
- Black pepper (ground and whole) - 100 g
- Turmeric powder - 25 g
- Onion powder - 25 g
- Garlic powder - 50 g
- Ginger powder - 25 g
- Rice (optional, for ground toasted rice in Kare-Kare) - 100 g
- Toasted sesame seeds - 100 g

Canned Goods

- Bamboo shoots (canned, no-salt-added) - 1 can (≈200 g drained weight)
- Water chestnuts (canned, sliced) - 1 can (≈200 g drained weight)
- Coconut cream (unsweetened) - 1 can (400 ml)
- Light coconut milk (unsweetened, no added sodium) - 1 can (400 ml)
- Chickpeas (low-sodium canned, drained and rinsed) - 1 can (400 g)
- Low-sodium vegetable broth - 3 l

Refrigerated Plant Milk

- Unseasoned soy milk (unsweetened, calcium-fortified) - 1 l carton